Since your goal is **Codeforces + DSA in C++**, I would optimise for **contest readiness**, not "becoming a C++ developer".

The target is:

> In 4 weeks, be comfortable solving Div 2 A/B/C problems without STL slowing you down.

Phase 1: STL Foundations (Week 1)

Goal: Become fluent with the STL containers and algorithms used in 80% of CP problems.

Day 1 — Vectors, Pairs, Iterators

Learn

- `vector`
- `pair`
- iterators
- range-based loops
- `auto`

Resources

Video

Luv STL Playlist - Vector and Pair Videos

Reading

USACO Guide STL Basics

Practice

Solve 5–10 problems requiring:

```
vector<int>
pair<int,int>
sort()
```

Day 2 — Sets and Maps

Learn

```
set
multiset
map
unordered_map
```

Important Functions

```
insert
erase
find
count
```

Resources

Video

Continue Luv playlist.

Reading

cppreference Containers

Practice

Frequency counting problems.

Typical pattern:

```
map<int,int> freq;
freq[x]++;
```

Day 3 — Algorithms

Learn

```
sort
reverse
find
count
binary_search
lower_bound
upper_bound
```

Resource

cppreference Algorithms Library

Practice

Search and sorting problems.

Day 4 — Stack, Queue, Deque

Learn

```
stack
queue
deque
```

Practice

Simple simulation problems.

Day 5 — Priority Queue

Learn

```
priority_queue<int>
```

and

```
priority_queue<
    int,
    vector<int>,
    greater<int>
>
```

Practice

Top K elements.

Day 6–7 — STL Revision

Build a cheatsheet.

For every STL container write:

```
Declaration
Insertion
Deletion
Search
Complexities
```

Phase 2: Competitive Programming STL (Week 2)

Now start learning the STL pieces that appear constantly in contests.

Day 8

Learn

```
string
stringstream
```

Resource:

[cppreference String Library]

Day 9

Learn

`next_permutation`

Practice

Permutation generation problems.

Day 10

Learn

Custom comparators.

```
sort(v.begin(), v.end(),
     [](int a, int b){
         return a>b;
     });
```

Day 11

Learn

`vector<pair<int,int>>`

Sorting pairs.

Day 12

Learn

`multiset`

Very common in Div2 C/D.

Day 13

Learn

```
unordered_map
unordered_set
```

Understand average O(1).

Day 14

Revision.

Attempt a 2-hour virtual contest.

Use only STL.

Phase 3: DSA + STL Together (Week 3)

Now STL becomes a tool instead of the topic.

Binary Search

Resource:

USACO Guide Binary Search

Learn:

```
lower_bound
upper_bound
```

inside real problems.

Prefix Sums

Resource:

CP Handbook (free PDF)

Read:

- Prefix sums
- Range queries

Two Pointers

Resource:

USACO Guide Two Pointers

Sliding Window

Often uses:

```
map
unordered_map
deque
```

Phase 4: Contest Readiness (Week 4)

Now stop learning STL.

Start solving.

Daily

2 Codeforces A Problems

2 Codeforces B Problems

1 CSES Problem

Resources

CSES Problem Set

CSES Problem Set

This is probably the best free DSA practice source.

Codeforces

Codeforces Problemset

CP Handbook

Competitive Programmer’s Handbook PDF

Read alongside solving.

Resources Ranked

If I had to pick only 5:

1. Luv STL Playlist

Luv STL Playlist

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2. USACO Guide

USACO Guide

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3. CSES Problem Set

CSES Problem Set

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4. Competitive Programmer's Handbook

Competitive Programmer's Handbook

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5. cppreference

cppreference

STL Mastery Checklist

Before moving to harder DSA, you should be able to write from memory:

```
vector
pair
map
set
multiset
unordered_map
unordered_set
stack
queue
deque
priority_queue
```

```
sort
binary_search
lower_bound
upper_bound
next_permutation

lambda comparator

auto
range based loops
```

Once these are second nature, the highest ROI topics are:

1. Binary Search
2. Prefix Sums
3. Two Pointers
4. Sliding Window
5. Greedy
6. Recursion & Backtracking
7. Trees
8. Graphs
9. DP

That’s roughly the progression followed by many strong Codeforces users. You can paste this directly into a document and export it as a PDF study plan.